

CivicEye Repository — Audit of Mistakes & Anti-Patterns

9 Critical & Major Flaws

Complete technical inventory of original repository flaws in Manish6201-g/civic-eye

Executive Summary: The repository was completely broken on fresh clone. The entire source code was committed as an unextracted `src.zip` binary file, entry points referenced missing files, an outdated `esbuild` peer dependency broke `npm install`, unmaintained duplicate prototypes polluted root, and missing `.gitignore` rules risked leaking local database records.

2

Critical (Showstoppers)

2

High (Build Failures)

3

Medium (Architecture)

2

Low (Config & Meta)

1. Source Code Committed as Compressed Archive (`src.zip`)

CRITICAL

THE MISTAKE:

The entire source tree (React frontend & Express backend) was uploaded as a 36 KB binary file `src.zip` in commit `82a3e21` instead of committing actual code files into git.

IMPACT:

Upon running `git clone`, the repository contained no `src/` directory. None of the TypeScript code was visible to Git, developers, code review tools, or CI/CD pipelines.

2. Broken Entry Point Imports (Immediate Runtime & Build Crash)

CRITICAL

THE MISTAKE:

Both primary application entry points pointed to files that did not exist on disk:

```
<!-- index.html (Line 18) -->
<script type="module" src="/src/main.tsx"></script> <!-- FILE NOT FOUND -->

// server.ts (Line 9)
import { apiRouter } from './src/backend/routes.js'; // FILE NOT FOUND
```

IMPACT:

Executing `npm run dev` or `npm run build` immediately crashed with fatal module resolution errors.

3. Incompatible Peer Dependency Lock in `package.json`

HIGH

THE MISTAKE:

`package.json` hardcoded an outdated `"esbuild": "^0.25.0"` in `devDependencies`, which conflicted with `"vite": "^8.3.0"` (requiring `esbuild@^0.27.0 || ^0.28.0`):

```
npm error code ERESOLVE
npm error Could not resolve dependency:
npm error peerOptional esbuild@"^0.27.0 || ^0.28.0" from vite@8.3.2
npm error Conflicting peer dependency: esbuild@0.28.2
```

IMPACT:

Running standard `npm install` failed completely with an `ERESOLVE` exit code 1. Developers could not install packages without forcing resolutions.

4. Missing Database Exclusion in `.gitignore`

HIGH

THE MISTAKE:

`src/backend/db.ts` creates and mutates an atomic local database at `data/civiceye_db.json`. However, the repository's `.gitignore` omitted `data/`.

IMPACT:

Running the server created local database records on disk that would be staged and committed to Git, polluting the commit history with test data, transient hashes, and mock municipal reports.

5. Duplicate Abandoned Prototype Files with Spaces in Filenames

MEDIUM

THE MISTAKE:

Three abandoned prototype files from commit `5fbd818` were left loose in the root alongside newer files:

- `idea 3.css` (1,968 lines) vs `idea3.css` (1,665 lines)
- `idea 3.html` (1,055 lines) vs `idea3.html` (973 lines)
- `idea 3.js` (284 lines) vs `idea3.js` (884 lines)

IMPACT:

Spaces in filenames break CLI scripts and require URL escaping (`idea%203.html`). In addition, `idea 3.js` contained non-functional dummy alerts while `idea3.js` had real API integrations.

6. Flat Root Clutter & Lack of Prototype Isolation

MEDIUM

THE MISTAKE:

Six standalone prototype files (`idea3.html` , `idea3.css` , `idea3.js` , plus the 3 spaced copies) were dumped directly into the repository root alongside Vite config, package.json, and TypeScript configs.

IMPACT:

No clean architectural boundary between the modern React build system and the legacy vanilla prototype; ambiguity regarding which file was the main web interface.

7. Disconnected Prototype Route in Backend Server (`server.ts`)

MEDIUM

THE MISTAKE:

The documentation promised access to the vanilla prototype alongside the React app, but `server.ts` had no route or static mount to serve the prototype files while running in dev middleware mode.

IMPACT:

Navigating to the prototype through the running development server resulted in 404 Not Found or fallback to the React SPA index.

8. Deprecated CommonJS Construct in ESM Bundler (`vite.config.ts`)

LOW

THE MISTAKE:

In `vite.config.ts` , `__dirname` was used inside an ES module package (`"type": "module"`):

```
'@': path.resolve(__dirname, '.') // __dirname is deprecated in Vite 8 Native ConfigLoader
```

IMPACT:

Vite 8 raised deprecation warnings on every build: `"Your Vite config uses features that are unsupported by configLoader: 'native'"`.

9. Generic Template Metadata in `package.json`

LOW

THE MISTAKE:

`package.json` was left with boilerplate project metadata: `"name": "react-example"` and `"version": "0.0.0"` , instead of identifying as the CivicEye platform.

IMPACT:

Package identity mismatch in npm tooling, Docker builds, and deployment logs.